

The strategy adopted to prevent the effects of climate change within the framework of the United Nations

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Abstract ;	Article info
This research paper aims to shed light on a critical topic, which is considered one of the emerging topics that occupy the entire world: climate change. This simple study focuses on defining this negative phenomenon, emphasizing its seriousness and the extent of its threat to the continuation of life. This is naturally done by focusing on the efforts of the United Nations to confront this dangerous phenomenon.	Received March 04.2025
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1. Introduction

There is no doubt that the climate change crisis facing humanity today is an unprecedented global environmental challenge in terms of size and impact. This necessitates the need to take strict and decisive measures very urgently because simply adapting to its future repercussions will be more complex and costly due to the impact of pollution on various elements of the environment surrounding humans.

Given the global nature of this crisis, any effort made individually by countries or regions will, unfortunately, have limited impact unless international efforts are combined in an integrated manner to address this dangerous phenomenon. In this context, the United Nations plays a pivotal role in addressing the climate change crisis through many international initiatives and efforts to protect the environment and enhance climate security.

Accordingly, through this study, we will try to raise the following question: To what extent can the United Nations play an effective role in addressing the phenomenon of climate change?

To answer this question, we relied on the descriptive and analytical approach, by shedding light on this sensitive issue that the entire world suffers from, and this is naturally done by searching for ways to address and confront it by addressing the efforts of the United Nations in this field. Accordingly, we will address the definition of the phenomenon of climate change, its causes, and its effects first. Then we seek to study the most important international efforts made by the United Nations to confront the phenomenon of climate change second.

First: The conceptual framework of the climate change phenomenon

The climate change phenomenon resulting from the escalation of human activities has led to a clear threat to global security, as well as the increase in the consumption of non-renewable energy, and it has been called the escalating crisis or the creeping disaster (Muj Fahd, 2018, p. 11), because it is considered one of the most prominent challenges facing humanity at present, and this has been confirmed by climate and earth scientists, as the climate is witnessing continuous changes that naturally negatively affect human life, and this necessitates the need to address its most important causes and effects.

1- Definition of the climate change crisis:

The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change has defined it as: "A change in the state of the climate that can be known through changes in the rate or variables in its characteristics that last for a long period, usually for decades or more, and refers to any change in the climate over time, whether as a result of natural changes or resulting from human activity" (The Intergovernmental Panel is an international scientific body established in 1988 by the United Nations Environment), and climate change is also meant as a shift in the climate resulting directly or indirectly from human activities, which leads to a change in the composition of the Earth's atmosphere. (Article 1, paragraph 2 of the United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change, adopted in 1992 during the "Earth Summit" in Rio de Janeiro, the Convention includes 197 parties, 1994)

Therefore, we say that climate change is a shift in the characteristics of the Earth's climate as a result of the increasing concentration of gases resulting from combustion processes in the atmosphere, and this is due to human activities that lead to an increase in the temperature of the atmosphere. The most prominent manifestations of this change include rising

temperatures and different patterns of rainfall in terms of quantity and timing as well, which affect the water cycle and its various processes.

2- Causes of the climate change crisis

There are a group of motives that led to the development of the climate change phenomenon, which can be divided into two main points, which are:

A- Natural causes:

Among the various factors that contributed very significantly to the major changes in the Earth's climate, and this is a confirmation of recent research that sheds light on the important role played by natural factors in this dangerous phenomenon, the extent of which is still controversial, and among these natural factors such as volcanic eruptions (Tsadith, 2015, p. 7),

where volcanic activities affect the energy balance between the climate and the Earth and emit large amounts of air particles and buried gases that act as a natural barrier to solar radiation, which reduces its access to the Earth's surface, which naturally results in a decrease in its temperature.

The dry and semi-dry regions also witness frequent dust storms as a result of the deterioration of the vegetation cover, weak agricultural activity, and low rainfall. Examples of these include the Khamaseen winds and the dust they raise in the atmosphere. In addition, the sunspot phenomenon occurs as a result of the disturbance of the sun's magnetic field, which helps to raise the temperature of the radiation emitted from it. (Abu Radi, 2011, p. 180)

B- Artificial causes:

Since the appearance of man on Earth, he has caused radical changes in nature, whether these changes are positive or negative. Scientists have concluded that the rise in the temperature of the Earth's

surface air during the twentieth century is mainly due to the dominance of human activity, which has become influential enough today to outweigh natural changes (Muharab, 2011, p. 250).

Therefore, these activities are mainly linked to the increasing population growth in the entire world, such as gases emitted from various factories and the products of agricultural activities, in addition to the campaign to remove forests and trees, which are considered the largest source of absorbing greenhouse gases (Abu Radi, 2011, p. 180).

3- The effects of climate change

Despite the difficulty of accurately predicting the devastating effects of climate change, whether in terms of timing or severity, we are well aware that the planet Earth faces serious risks shortly. The United Nations Framework Convention on Climate Change has addressed the effects of climate change by stating that the term "climate change" refers to the transformations that occur in the natural or biological environment due to climate change, which may naturally affect the formation or productivity of natural ecosystems as well as the performance of systems in various fields or human health and well-being. Based on the above, we will address the effects of climate change (Article1, paragraph 1 of the United Nations Framework Convention, p. 03), for example, which are represented in the following:

- Increased frequency of severe heat waves and at the same time decreased cold waves, which doubles the spread of carbon dioxide in particular and other different and dangerous gases at the same time.

- Melting of ice sheets in different regions of the world, as is the case with the North and South Poles, and in some cases, a significant number of icy areas have disappeared due to rising temperatures. (Nasima & Laroussi, 2023, pp. 92-93)

- The rise in sea levels and oceans has happened recently at a rate of 0.1 and 0.2 meters, and this will inevitably lead to the submergence and drowning of many coastal countries, the displacement of populations, and the disappearance of agricultural lands...

- The frequency of natural disasters such as earthquakes, volcanoes, drought, floods, insect invasions, landslides, and storms. (Tsadith, 2015, p. 97)

- The fermentation of free solid waste resulting from the growth of a very large number of microorganisms leads to the production of huge quantities of greenhouse gases such as methane gas (Forouhat, 2012, p. 139).

- It has been confirmed that the increase in the practice of various industrial and economic activities as well as the increase in demographic growth by 6 times in the next 200 years are very important factors that help exacerbate global warming (Forouhat, 2012, p. 140), as all these scientific facts and others are considered an effective indicator of the beginning of the exacerbation of this dangerous phenomenon, and accordingly the international community must unite to activate decisions to reduce the rate of pollution worldwide.

Second: The most important international efforts made by the United Nations to confront the phenomenon of climate change

Most countries of the world are obligated to do everything in their power to mitigate the harmful effects of climate change by taking all necessary measures to eliminate or at least mitigate the occurrence of buried emissions (Al-Fakrein, 2006, p. 68). Accordingly, this commitment becomes an imperative necessity for developed countries in particular and developing countries in general because it is proven that protecting the environment from pollution has taken on a global dimension. Here, the international

community has become convinced of the seriousness of the current situation (Muj Fahd, 2018, p. 43), stressing that the continuation of this dangerous phenomenon will inevitably lead to the deterioration of life on planet Earth. Therefore, the issue of climate change has become a matter of interest to many countries more than ever before. Accordingly, specialized scientists have devoted all their efforts to searching for solutions that save the Earth from the damage resulting from it. Accordingly, the United Nations has played a vital role in this field, as it has devoted its efforts to supporting the issue of climate change at the international level, and on this basis, it has organized many meetings and conferences based on its conviction that addressing the causes and effects of global climate change can only be effective through integrated international cooperation (Mustafa, 2019, p. 25).

We will discuss the most prominent of these agreements and conferences. Aimed at reducing the aggravation of this dangerous phenomenon as follows:

A- International agreements:

1- Framework Convention on Climate Change:

To confront the phenomenon of climate change, this agreement was concluded during the summit conference, which was held in the Brazilian city of Rio de Janeiro in 1992, and after signing in 1993 and ratifying it on March 21, 1994, we find that it was not binding on the States Parties, but rather came in the form of a recommendation only (Boukandura, 2022), and accordingly, we find that Article 2 of the agreement (Article 2, of the United Nations Framework Convention, previous reference, p. 4) stipulates a set of goals that the agreement seeks to achieve, in addition to the text of Article 4 as well, which included a set of obligations that fall on the States Parties to the agreement and its confirmation that the responsibility on their

shoulders is shared even if it is different (Article2, of the United Nations Framework Convention, previous reference, p. 5), so cooperation is considered an absolute necessity to protect the environment from climate change.

2- The Intergovernmental Panel on Climate Change:

The World Meteorological Organization and the United Nations Environment Program established this body in 1988. It is an international organization affiliated with the United Nations (htt7), and its role is limited only to evaluating and reviewing various scientific, economic, and social documents related to climate change. In October 2018, the body issued a special report on the effects of global warming of 1.5 degrees Celsius. This report also confirmed that many effects of climate change can be avoided by limiting the rise in the Earth's temperature to 1.5 degrees Celsius compared to 2 degrees Celsius or more (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 125). Among the most important conclusions of the body on climate variables are the following: (Mihoubi, 2011, p. 72)

- The human factor "humans" is responsible for 90 percent of the changes affecting the global climate.

- The possibility that the changes that have occurred in the global climate in recent years are due only to natural factors has been ruled out.

- Human activity is responsible for the increase in greenhouse gas emissions.

- The decline in the ability of the Earth and oceans to absorb carbon dioxide.

With the continuation of extreme heat waves and heavy rainfall, tropical cyclones will likely become more severe.

- Continuation of the rise in carbon dioxide and various gases in the seas for more than 1000 years. (Fathi, 2024, p. 239)

B- International conferences:

Given that climate change is a transboundary phenomenon, it has led the

international community to take several measures to establish controls that limit its spread (Boukandura, 2022, p. 386), and to achieve this it has become necessary to coordinate efforts between countries collectively, which has led to the holding of many conferences related to this dangerous phenomenon and under the supervision of the United Nations, including, but not limited to, the following:

1- Copenhagen Climate Conference:

This conference was held under the auspices of the United Nations from 7 to 18 December with the attendance of representatives of 192 countries in Denmark to discuss the issue of climate change and to work on developing an effective strategy aimed at reducing greenhouse gas emissions resulting from the burning of coal, oil and gas. It also seeks to find a new international mechanism so that it is ready for ratification and entry into force in 2013. (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 164)

2- Canon Climate Change Conference:

It was held during the period from 29 November to 10 December 2010, in Mexico. It aims to reduce heat emissions, which are the main cause of climate change. This was done by searching for a compromise that satisfies all the participating countries (Rashi, 2020, p. 212). At the end of the conference, many decisions were made that aim to: (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 164)

- Help countries move towards a low-emission future.

- Emphasizing keeping the Earth's temperature at two degrees Celsius.

- Establishing the Green Fund to support and finance the climate in the long term and support developing countries.

- Facilitating access to the latest technologies and international funding for many projects undertaken by countries to

reduce carbon emissions and protect the environment.

- Enhancing cooperation between countries, especially in the field of technology.

3- Durban Climate Conference:

The United Nations Climate Change Conference was held in Durban, South Africa, in December 2011, with the participation of 194 countries. Accordingly, the States Parties agreed on a package of decisions (Rashi, 2020, p. 212), including the following:

- The need to expand the scope of efforts made by the States Parties, which were previously stipulated in the Kyoto Conference in 1997.

- Emphasizing the provision of additional incentives for new investments in the field of technology and infrastructure necessary to combat the phenomenon of climate change.

4- During the opening of the Climate Change Summit, the Secretary-General of the United Nations called on the countries that signed the Paris Agreement 2015 to fulfill all the promises they made, all to eliminate this dangerous phenomenon and reduce the rate of global warming to between 1.5 and 2 degrees Celsius (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 165), in addition to the need to reduce carbon dioxide emissions by half before 2030. The World Bank has revealed the allocation of \$200 billion over 5 years, starting in 2021, to support projects in the field of renewable energy, as well as support projects that contribute to reducing emissions. (Boukandura, 2022, p. 388)

From the above, we say that all these agreements, conferences, and meetings are of great importance, and this is evident through achieving a global consensus among all the parties to the issue of climate change, which is a very dangerous phenomenon that in turn requires a comprehensive international response. However, progress in finding a solution to this problem is taking place at a very slow

pace, as the efforts made that are commensurate with the size of the challenges posed have succeeded in uniting countries, regardless of their circumstances, to work together in an attempt to find a quick and appropriate solution to it.

Third: Contribution of civil society to supporting the efforts of the United Nations to combat climate change

The international community's interest in the issue of climate change and its serious cross-border effects has led to the emergence of civil society organizations as some of the most important people interested in the issue of addressing the phenomenon of climate change, based on what is provided by them within the framework of improving and reforming the environmental strategy, whether at the national or international level. Of course, this is done by spreading awareness among society about the serious consequences of the issue of climate change, in addition to emphasizing the role of various media outlets, both audio and visual, in providing periodic reports with full credibility about this dangerous phenomenon. (The role of civil society organizations in combating climate change, 2025)

Accordingly, civil society can address the phenomenon of climate change through a set of strategies, which we can mention, for example, but not limited to, the following (Saad Abdullah, 2020, pp. 352-353):

- Raising the level of general awareness of civil society, especially in how to deal with the risks of climate change, and this is of course done by periodically participating in seminars, home visits, and international conferences by people involved in these associations, and this reflects the voice of international communities.

- Trying to stand firm with the relevant government agencies, and this is

done by meeting and fully coordinating with them while presenting logical solutions, suggestions, and alternatives that serve the environment and confront climate change.

- Working on developing plans to improve performance, so that civil society organizations and state institutions must support the general framework of the state plan and not be isolated from it so that all plans and strategies are integrated.

- Emphasizing the dissemination of information on successful experiences and those related to confronting the phenomenon of climate change, and this is of course done through the exchange of information and experiences during mutual visits between countries.

- Emphasizing the effective role of the media in the field of educating civil society, especially in the field of climate and climate change, as it helps climate scientists to communicate their opinions and knowledge to civil society in a good way, in addition to trying to adapt and facilitate access to information on how to adapt and adapt to the phenomenon of climate change.

- Civil society always focuses on supporting vulnerable communities and those most affected by climate change and confronting its harmful effects, such as coastal and agricultural communities, and this is done by providing the necessary resources and assistance (Saad Abdullah, 2020, p. 366).

- Emphasizing the contribution of civil society in monitoring the extent of countries' commitment to international agreements on climate change, and also calling for the necessity of applying the principle of transparency and accountability if the climate strategy is not implemented.

- Emphasizing civil society on the necessity of raising awareness and educating students in schools and educational institutions, and university

students on climate change issues and their negative effects on the world as a whole, as well as emphasizing the importance of developing an effective future strategy to confront this dangerous phenomenon . (Abdel-Qader, 2024, p. 180)

- Calling on civil society to unite to stand as one man in "the supervisory role" on private institutions related to the environment regarding the extent of their commitment to implementing all policies, laws, and regulations related to climate change, and this of course falls within the framework of international obligations, as all of this and that is done through issuing periodic reports on the work of these institutions (The role of civil society organizations in combating climate change, 2025)

Accordingly, through the above, we say that civil society contributes greatly to strengthening global efforts to confront the phenomenon of climate change, and this is of course through achieving the goals and strategies that have been developed and drawn up by civil society organizations.

Fourth: The relationship between climate change and environmental displacement

In the past few years, many scientists and experts in the field of climate have suggested that climate conditions may be a direct cause of the displacement of many, even thousands of people in search of a haven to live in. Therefore, the undesirable environmental changes that naturally arise directly from climate change will have a direct impact on human life as a result of their inability to live and survive in their original homeland.

Reports are confirming that the average number of people displaced within their countries annually in the period between 2008 and 2020 reached approximately 21.80 million people, and this is due to climate disasters including drought, extreme heat, desertification,

floods, forest fires, storms, and others. (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 211)

The head of the Migration, Environment, and Climate Change Department at the International Organization for Migration also stated that there are predictions for the twenty-first century that more people will be forced to migrate to other places as a result of the severe climate effects (Hassan, 2021, p. 118) and that climate-induced migration is an inevitable reality, and that the international community is in a special challenge to this dangerous phenomenon.

Therefore, we can mention some examples, for example, of some countries that suffer from the environmental displacement crisis. We find that the Lake Chad Basin suffers from very serious environmental degradation, which has forced the population to migrate to safer places. The same is true for Ethiopia and Bangladesh, which suffer from double pressure due to internal environmental and climate displacement, and at the same time receive very large numbers of displaced people from neighboring countries. All of this is due to a scarcity of water resources in those areas. (Othman, 2023, p. 88)

At this particular point, environmental migration is the only solution to reach or obtain a drop of water. Environmental displacement is also the result of storms and hurricanes, such as what happened in the Republic of Fiji, which had a devastating impact on the citizens and was the reason for the migration of thousands of indigenous people. More than 60 villages were moved to other places to reduce people's exposure to serious damage resulting from climate change. Accordingly, through the above, we say that the phenomenon of climate change is considered one of the most important issues that have a close relationship with the risks of environmental degradation, which requires the cooperation and union of the international

community as a whole to reach scientific and practical solutions at the same time related to the climate phenomenon according to the reports issued periodically by the parties concerned with the climate factor, namely the International Panel on Climate Change. (Al-Faqih, 2024, p. 213)

All of this confirms that climate change has become and continues to negatively affect human capabilities on the one hand and work to destabilize the international community as a whole on the other hand, because, simply put, climate change has become a direct cause of the exacerbation of the phenomenon of human displacement and migration, the latter may be internal, but its effects extend beyond the national borders of countries.

Conclusion:

The issue of climate change is considered one of the emerging issues. It is considered a very dangerous phenomenon for the international community as a whole because its effects cross borders, which requires the necessity of everyone's cooperation and unity. This can be done by knocking on the door of the United Nations, which is working hard to find solutions for it, by holding many conferences, meetings, and agreements, all of which have one goal, which is to try to find appropriate solutions for this dangerous phenomenon.

Results:

- The phenomenon of climate change is among the most serious environmental problems, as man is the main cause of its occurrence as a result of the various actions practiced by him and the increasing demand for the use and exploitation of non-renewable energies.

- The phenomenon of climate change is a global phenomenon and its effects cross borders threatening the entire international community, so it requires everyone to unite to confront it.

- The United Nations has proven its effectiveness in confronting this dangerous

phenomenon by concluding many agreements and holding conferences and meetings that require the parties to adhere to them and not violate them.

Recommendations:

- Seek to increase the holding of scientific conferences and meetings related to the phenomenon of climate change, because it has an effective role in educating people about the importance of the environment and the need to preserve it.

- Call on the media to intensify awareness-raising media campaigns about the phenomenon of climate change and the extent of its danger to the international community as a whole, and call for the preservation of the environment.

- Strengthening the role of civil society through extensive participation in making environmental decisions and playing an effective role in confronting this dangerous phenomenon

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